

# Clinical Study Summary Report (CSSR)

Document Status: Final | Version: 1.0 | Date: 01-APR-2026

## 1. Administrative & Study Identification

|                          |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |
|--------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Full Study Title:        | Exploratory PPlatform Trial on Anti-Inflammatory Agents in Alzheimer's Disease (EXPLAIN-AD): A Randomized, Placebo-controlled, Multicenter Platform Study to Evaluate the Efficacy, Safety, Tolerability and Pharmacokinetics of Various Anti-inflammatory Agents in Patients With Mild Cognitive Impairment Due to Alzheimer's Disease and Mild Alzheimer's Disease |
| Short Title:             | Study of the Efficacy and Safety of Various Anti-inflammatory Agents in Participants With Mild Cognitive Impairment or Mild Alzheimer's Disease                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |
| Protocol Number:         | 342862574179924281                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |
| NCT Number:              | NCT04795466                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |
| Sponsor Name:            | Novartis                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             |
| Investigational Product: | canakinumab                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |
| Phase:                   | PHASE2                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               |
| Medical Monitor:         | [Not Provided in Posting]                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |

## 2. Study Synopsis & Rationale

### 2.1 Study Objective

**Primary Objective:** 1. Change From Baseline in Cognition as Measured by the Neuropsychological Test Battery (NTB) Z-scores: NTB is a composite of multiple neuropsychological tests that provide a thorough assessment of the cognitive domains affected by early Alzheimer's Disease (AD), in particular, memory, executive function, attention and verbal fluency. 5 out of 9 NTB components were administered in the study, Rey Auditory Verbal Learning Test (RAVLT) immediate and delayed scores, Wechsler Memory Scale Digit Span, Controlled Word Association Test (COWAT) and Category Fluency Test (CFT).

For each component a raw score was converted to z-score that indicates the number of standard deviations away from the mean. Total Z-score was derived by averaging all resulting z-scores. A change from baseline was calculated as post-baseline z-score minus pre-treatment z-score. A zero Z-score means no cognitive change, a negative value indicates decline, and a positive value means improvement.

**Secondary Obj.:** 1. Change From Baseline in Memory as Measured by the Total Composite NTB Memory Z-score 2. Change From Baseline in Executive Function as Measured by the Total Composite NTB Executive Function Z-score 3. Change From Baseline in Digit Symbol Substitution Test (DSST) Score - CANTAB

### 2.2 Background & Rationale

The purpose of this platform study was to evaluate the effect of anti-inflammatory agents on cognition in early Alzheimer's disease. Additionally, the safety and tolerability and their effects on central and peripheral inflammation were

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evaluated. Due to early termination only a single agent could be studied.

## 3. Study Design & Methodology

**Design Framework:** Type: INTERVENTIONAL, Phase: PHASE2, Status: TERMINATED

**Target N:** 34

## 4. Subject Selection (Eligibility Criteria)

### 4.1 Inclusion Criteria

- \* Male or female, age ≥ 45 years and ≤ 90 years at the time of signing the informed consent;
- \* Participant has a reliable study partner or caregiver can accompany the participant to all visits;
- \* A diagnosis of probable MCI due to AD or mild AD according to the National Institute on Aging and the Alzheimer's Association (NIA-AA) criteria;
- \* Confirmed amyloid and tau positivity via CSF sampling performed at screening;
- \* Mini-Mental State Examination (MMSE) total score of 20 to 24 (inclusive) at screening; OR, MMSE total score of 25-30 (inclusive) plus a DSST score at least 0.5 standard deviation (SD) below normative data at screening.

### 4.2 Exclusion Criteria

- \* Use of an investigational agent or an approved product with the intent to modulate inflammation or modulate the course of AD (e.g., Tau ASOs, gene therapy, amyloid or tau vaccine):
  - \* Previous use of small molecules is allowed if discontinued for at least five half-lives, or at least 30 days from when the expected pharmacodynamic effect has returned to baseline prior to screening, whichever is longer
  - \* Previous use of monoclonal or polyclonal antibodies or other biologics is allowed if discontinued for at least five half-lives prior to screening
- \* Current medical or neurological condition that might impact cognition or performance on cognitive assessments, e.g., MCI not due to AD, non-Alzheimer dementia, Huntington's disease, Parkinson's disease, stroke, schizophrenia, bipolar disorder, active major depression, multiple sclerosis (MS), amyotrophic lateral sclerosis (ALS), active seizure disorder, or history of traumatic brain injury associated with loss of consciousness and ongoing residual transient or permanent neurological signs/symptoms including cognitive deficits, and/or associated with skull fracture;
- \* Diagnosis of vascular dementia prior to screening (e.g., modified Hachinski Ischaemic Scale score ≤ 6 or those who meet the NINDS AIREN criteria for vascular dementia);

## 11. Study Identifiers & Governance

**Primary ID:** 342862574179924281

**Registry Number:** NCT04795466

**Sponsor:** Novartis

**Study Title:** Study of the Efficacy and Safety of Various Anti-inflammatory Agents in Participants With Mild Cognitive Impairment or Mild Alzheimer's Disease

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## 15. Sign-off & Approval

Principal Investigator: \_\_\_\_\_ Date: \_\_\_\_\_  
Clinical Operations Lead: \_\_\_\_\_ Date: \_\_\_\_\_  
Lead Statistician: \_\_\_\_\_ Date: \_\_\_\_\_